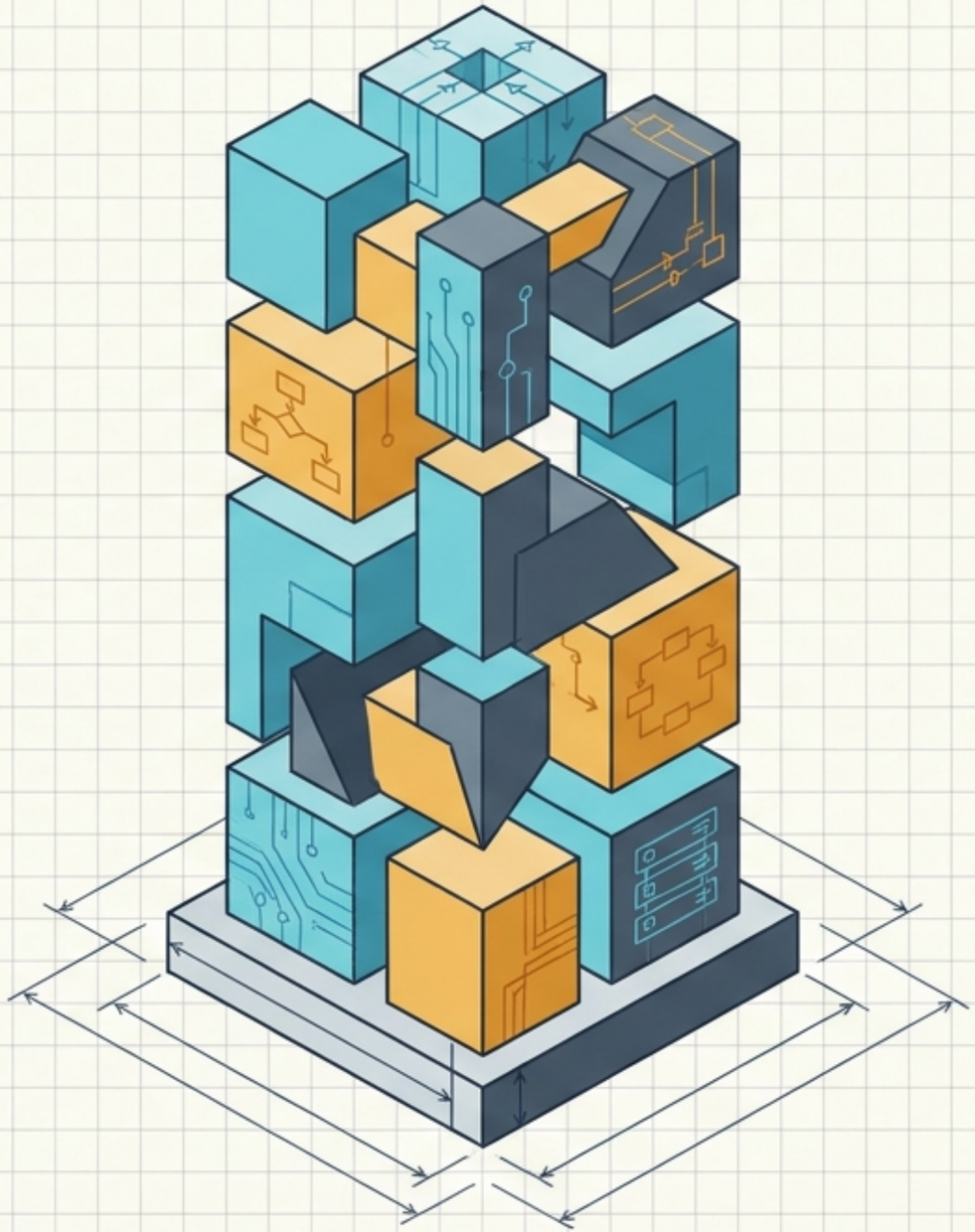
The IT Architecture Core: A Playbook for the Technology Strategist

Source Framework: IASA 10-Module Curriculum

Structural Paradigm: Dual-Engine (5 Capabilities + 4 Lifecycle Phases)

Core Mission: Translating business strategy into technical realities.



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The technology strategist sits between business and execution.

The Identity Matrix			
	Architect	**Developer**	**Project Manager**
Primary Focus	Business outcomes & long-term fit	Component creation & feature delivery	Scope, schedule, & budget control
Key Output	Translating strategy to direction	Building working software	Delivering work efficiently
Primary Constraint	Whole-system trade-offs	Technical limits & logic	Time & resource allocation

Technical skill alone doesn't make an architect.
Business **Technology Strategy** and **Human Dynamics** matter just as much.

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The ITA-ROI Model: Architecture creates measurable business value.

Value Equation Dashboard UI

The Investment (Costs)

- People
- Time
- Tooling



The Return

Tangible Value (Measurable Proxies)

- Reduced operational costs
- Less rework
- Faster delivery
- Avoided penalties

Intangible Value (Strategic Proxies)

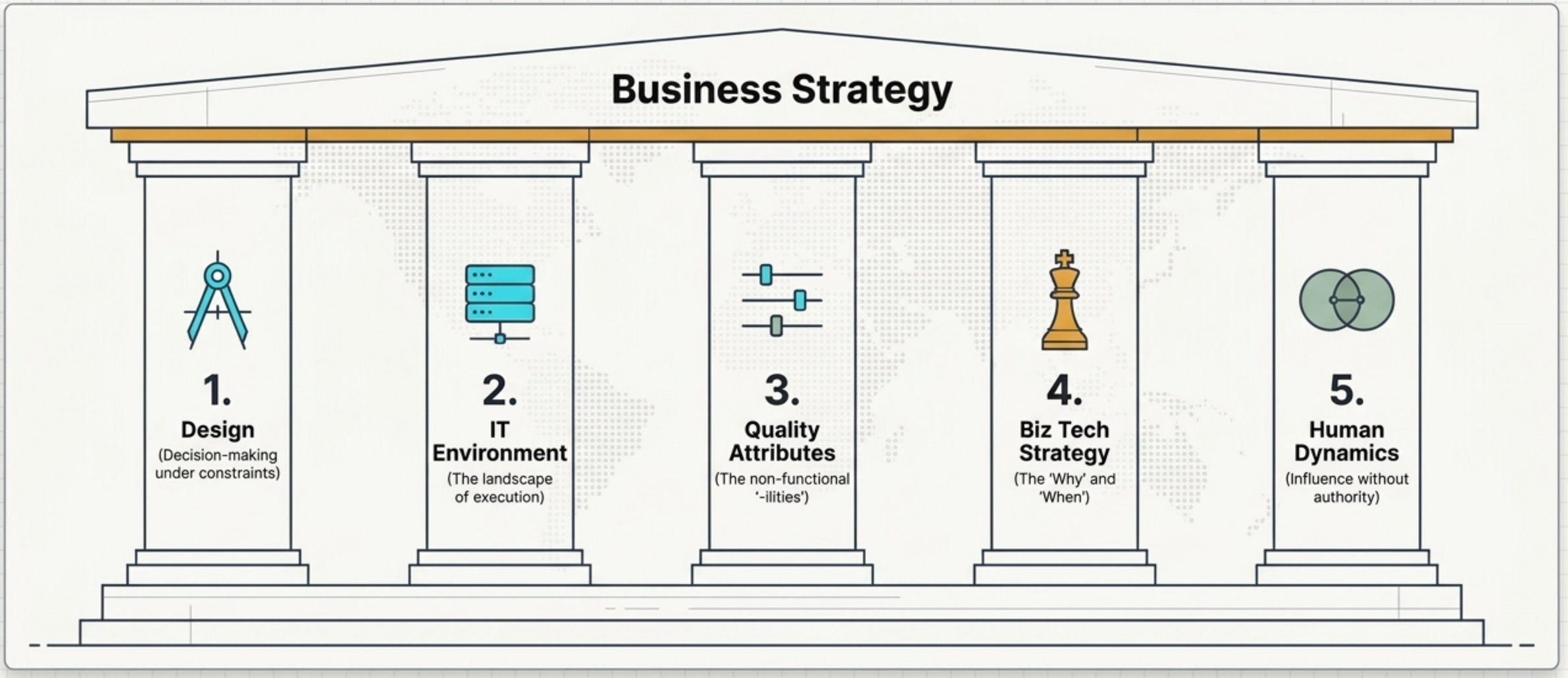
- Stronger stakeholder confidence
- Better business alignment
- Reduced risk exposure
- Greater agility

Value is estimated in the business case, tracked through creation, and measured post-delivery.

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The 5-Pillar Capability Framework is driven by global practice, not theory.

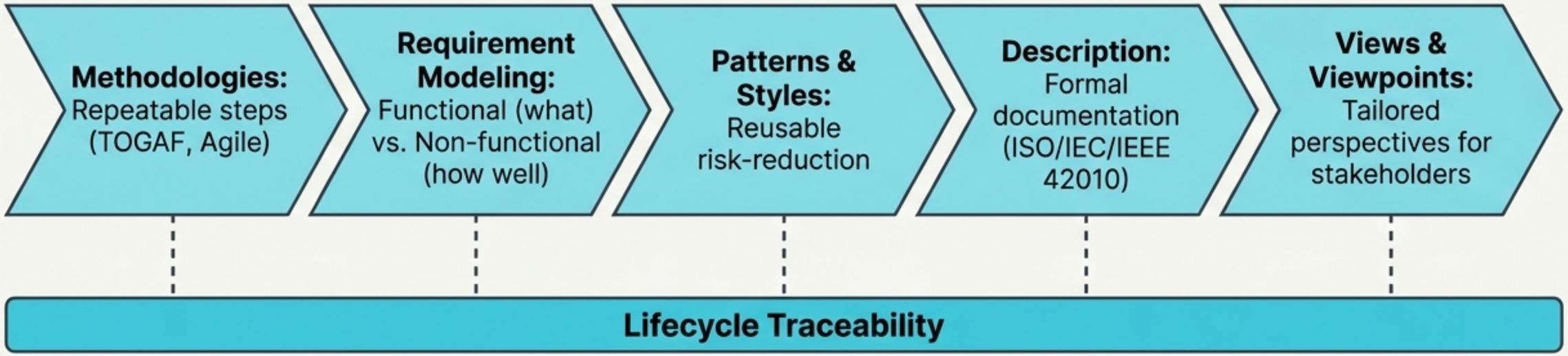
Based on the IASA global IT Architecture Skills Survey—a defined body of skills for practicing architects.



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Pillar 1: Design is the discipline of decision-making under constraints.

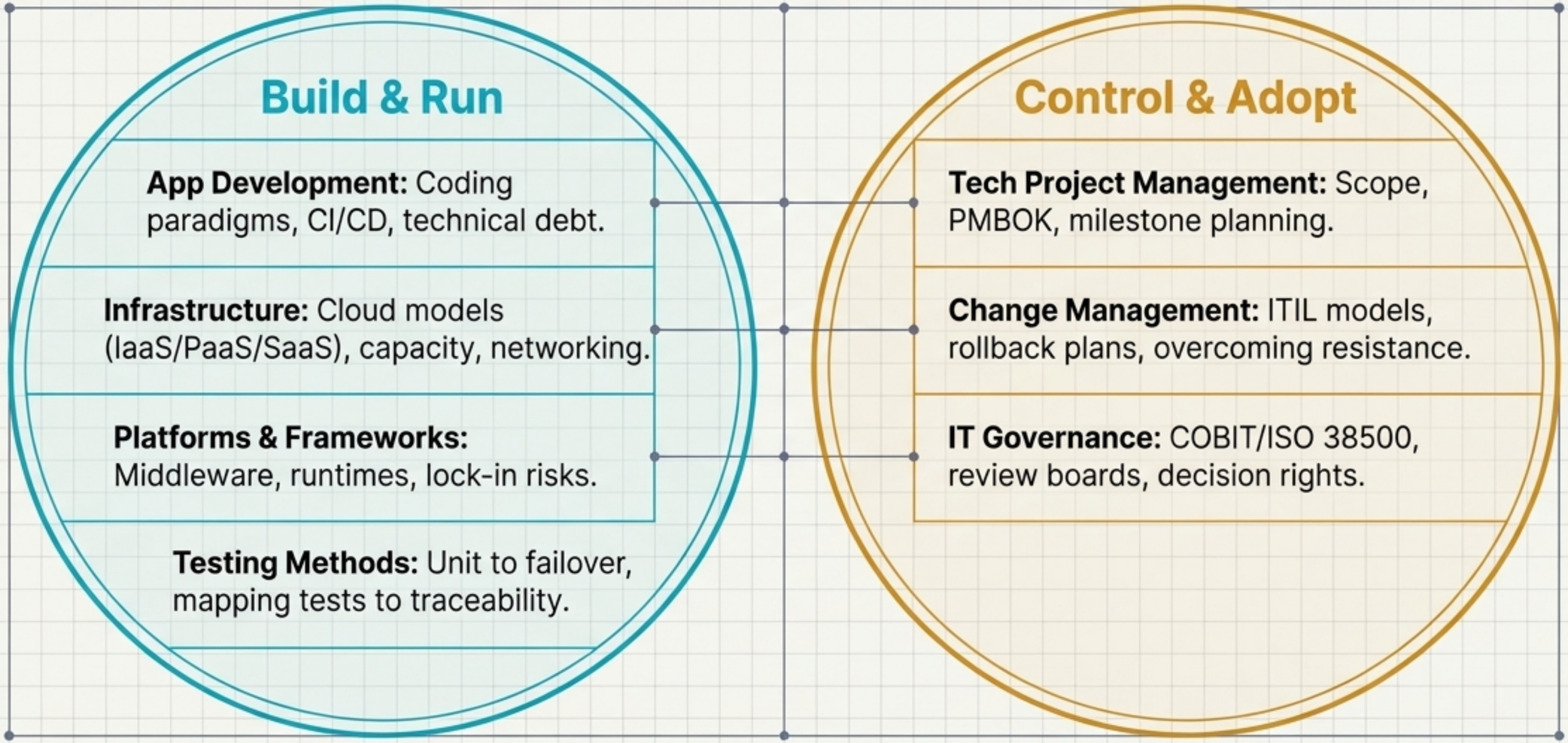
Whole System Thinking: Focus on boundaries and component interactions.



Every design element must trace back to a business requirement, and forward into delivery.

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Pillar 2: The IT Environment dictates what is feasible to build and adopt.



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Pillar 3: Quality Attributes dictate how well the system operates, forcing deliberate trade-offs.

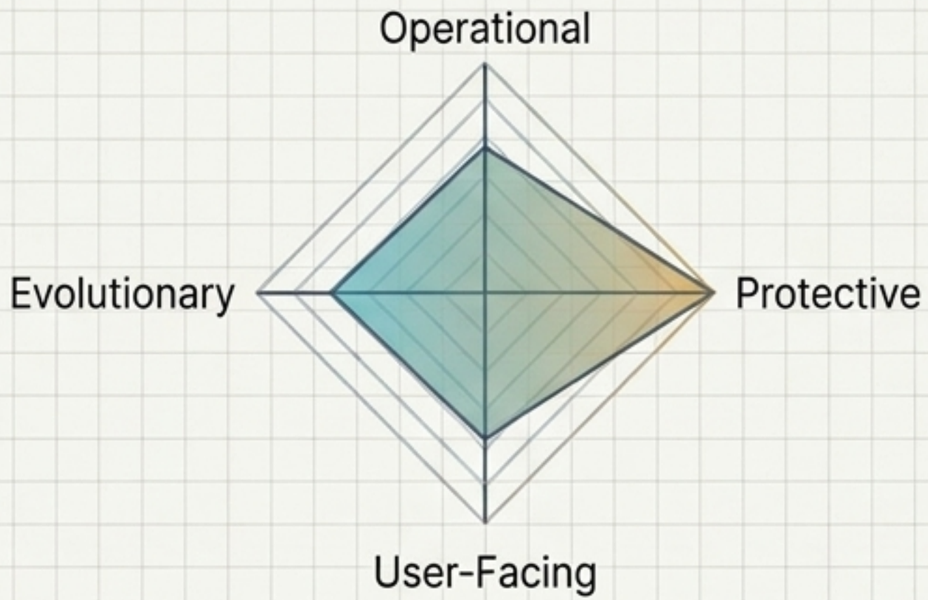
Operational

Performance, Reliability, Availability, Scalability.

Evolutionary

Flexibility, Maintainability, Extensibility.

The Trade-Off Radar



Protective

Security (The CIA Triad: Confidentiality, Integrity, Availability).

User-Facing

Accessibility (WCAG), Personality, Localization.

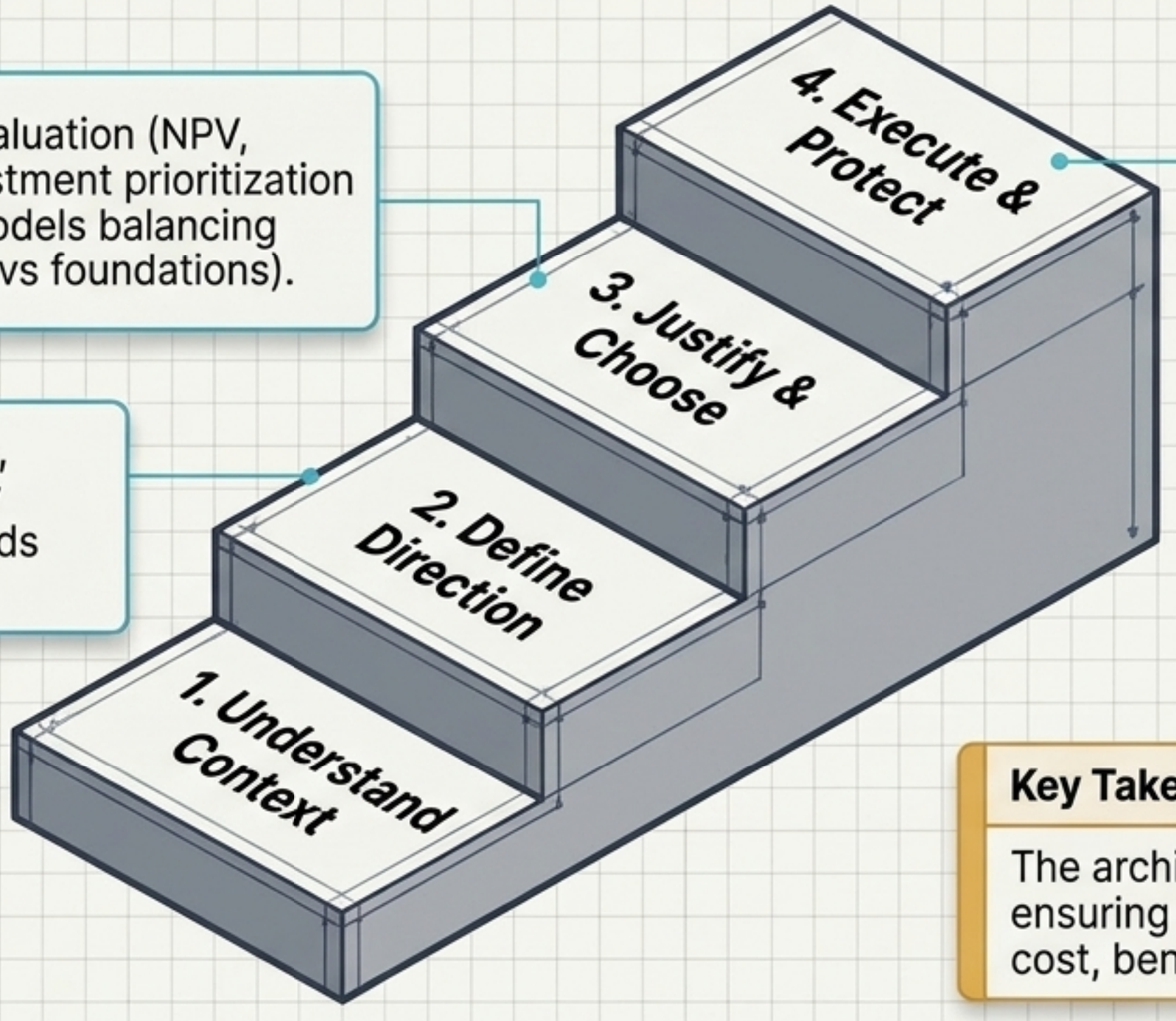
Trade-Off Metrics
Emphasizes evaluation methods like ATAM (Architecture Tradeoff Analysis Method) to agree on metrics before building.
Every attribute needs a measurable target (e.g., 95% of requests <2s) to be traded off meaningfully.

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Pillar 4: Technology choices start from business goals, not favorite frameworks.

Business valuation (NPV, TCO), investment prioritization (scoring models balancing quick wins vs foundations).

Strategy rationalization, requirements discovery (finding underlying needs vs. stated wants).



4. Execute & Protect: Architecture methods (Zachman/TOGAF), knowledge management, regulatory compliance.

Key Takeaway:

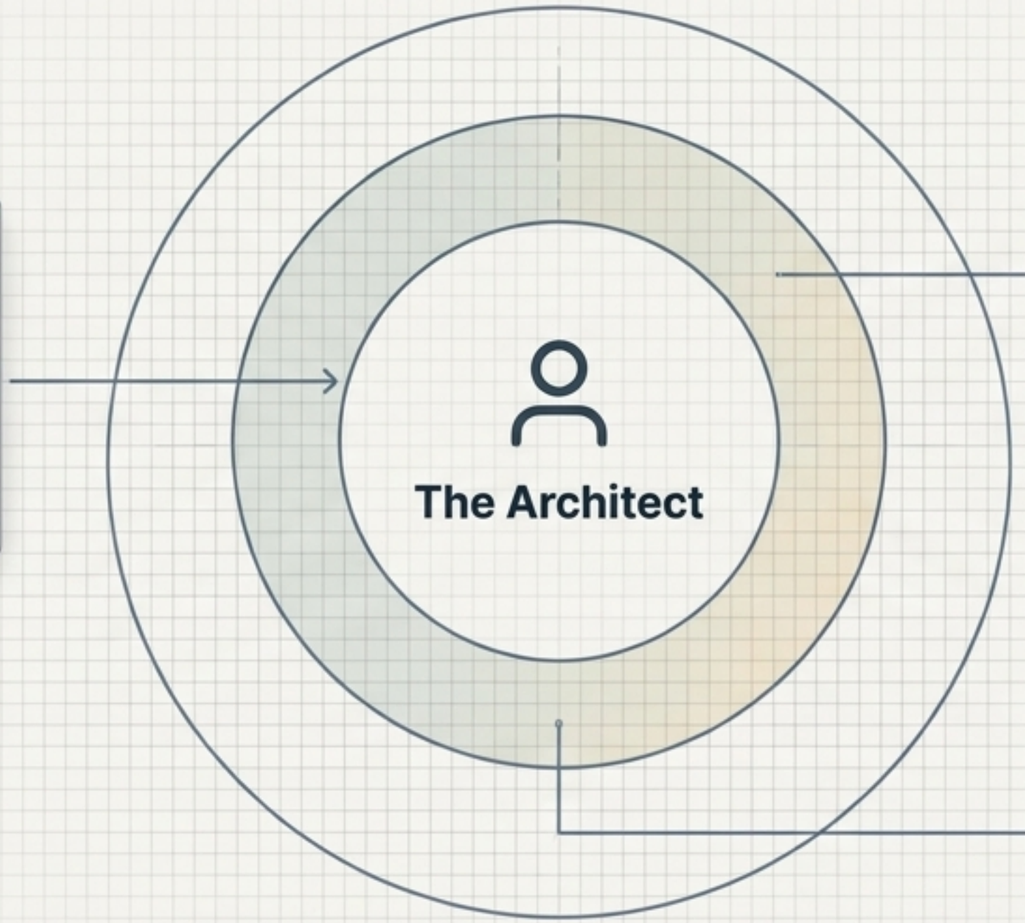
The architect acts as a value steward, ensuring every initiative is justifiable by cost, benefit, and risk.

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Pillar 5: A technically sound architecture delivers zero value if nobody adopts it.

Communicating Outward:

Presentation (ICEPAC methodology—tailoring outcomes outcomes for execs vs detail for engineers) and structured writing (business cases).



Relating & Working (Peers/Customers):

Peer interaction (design reviews), Customer relationship (managing expectations), Collaboration & Negotiation (focusing on interests over positions).

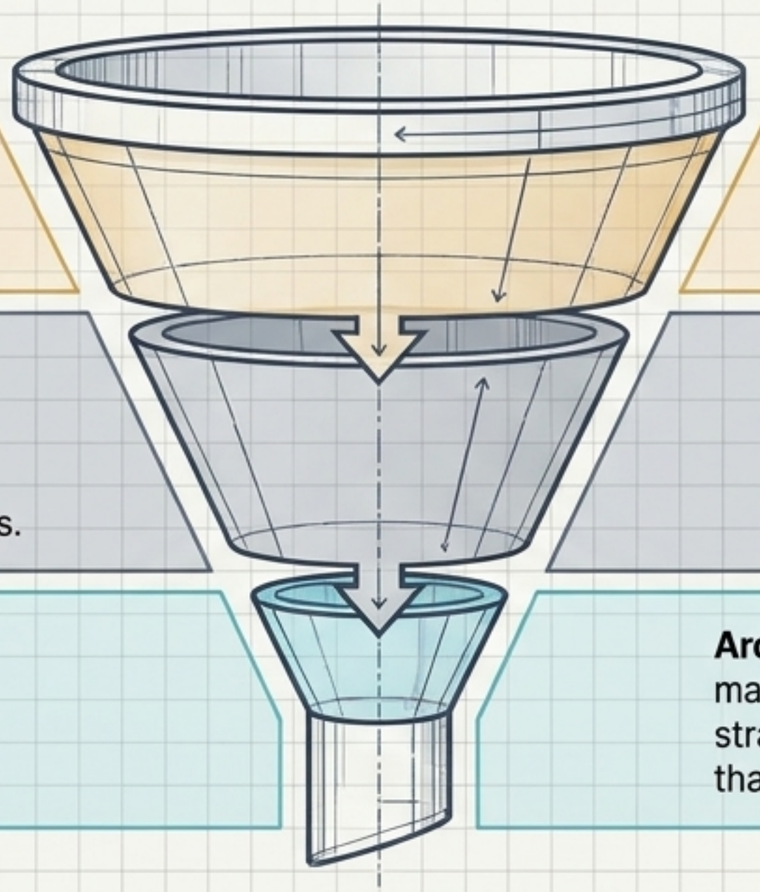
Shaping the Environment:

Leadership (inspiring without formal authority) and Managing Culture (working with existing norms before trying to shift them).

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Phase 1 (Selection): Architects have limited capacity; engagement must be strategic and proactive.

Project Selection Flow



Step 1: Triggers

New projects, major changes, or risk thresholds initiate the engagement model.

New shaltmmus comprent supponts.

Step 2: The Business Case Filter

Architects help define the problem, analyze options, and calculate value (ROI, Payback Period) weighing tangible vs. intangible benefits.

Architects scoring pre-piratication, and develop calitial project strategids.

Step 3: Governance & Assignment

Architecture Review Boards use scoring matrices to assign capacity proactively based on strategic fit and architectural significance, rather than reacting to failing projects.

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Phase 2 (Creation): Distilling abstract requirements into product-specific technical reality.

The Translation Funnel

Requirements: Gathering functional, non-functional, and constraint data.

↓

Logical Architecture (Generic): Tech-neutral. Defines functional components, layers, and flows. Focuses on the problem, avoids vendor lock-in.

↓

Product-Specific Architecture: Maps logical design to actual platforms. Weighs costs, skills, and limits.

↓

Views & Viewpoints Dictionary: Generates tailored artifacts (Logical view for analysts, Dev view for engineers, Physical view for ops)

The Abstraction Matrix

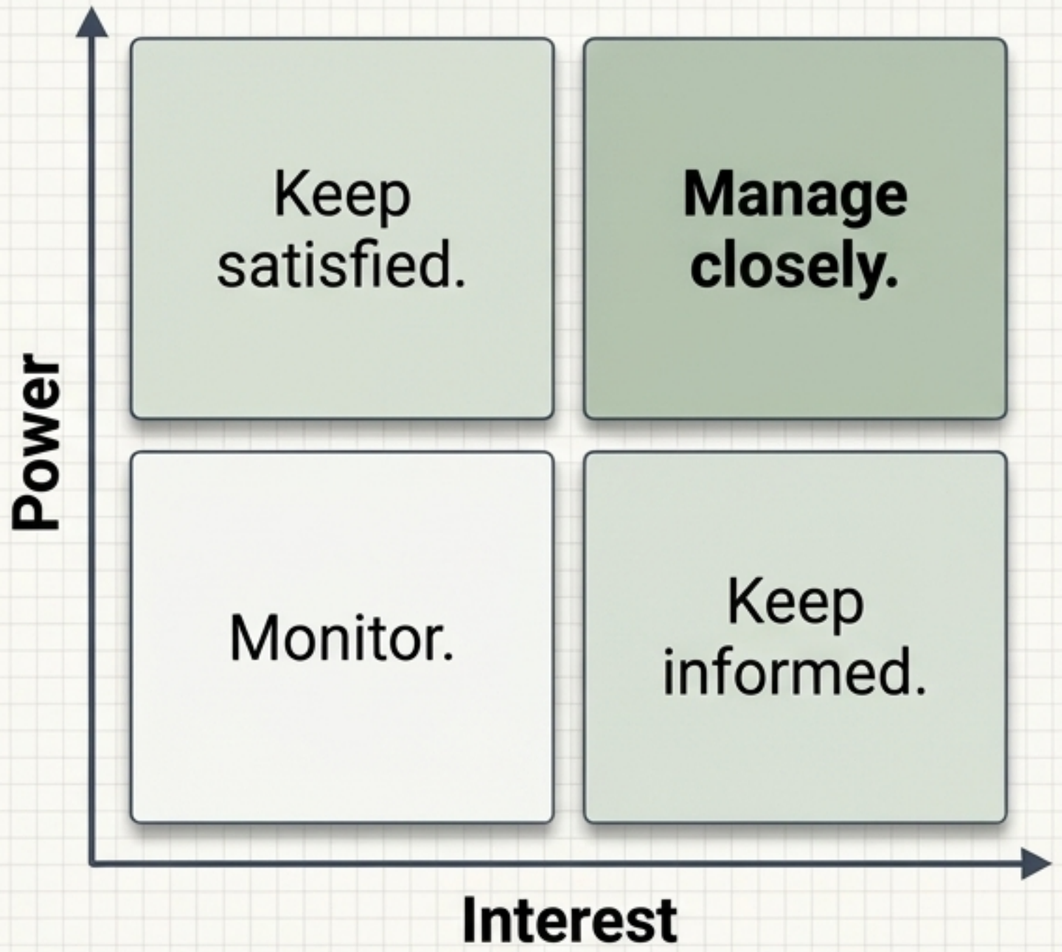
Logical Architecture (Generic)	Product-Specific Architecture
Focuses purely on the problem.	Focuses on implementation limits.
Technology and vendor neutral.	Constrained by actual platforms.
Protects against lock-in.	Commits to cost, licensing, & skills.

Check every product choice against the quality attribute targets set in Phase 1.

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Phase 3 (Delivery): Managing stakeholders and artifacts to prevent architectural drift.

Stakeholder Influence Grid



Delivery & Artifact Control



Architects don't run the project (PMs do), but they monitor governance checkpoints to stop implementation drift.

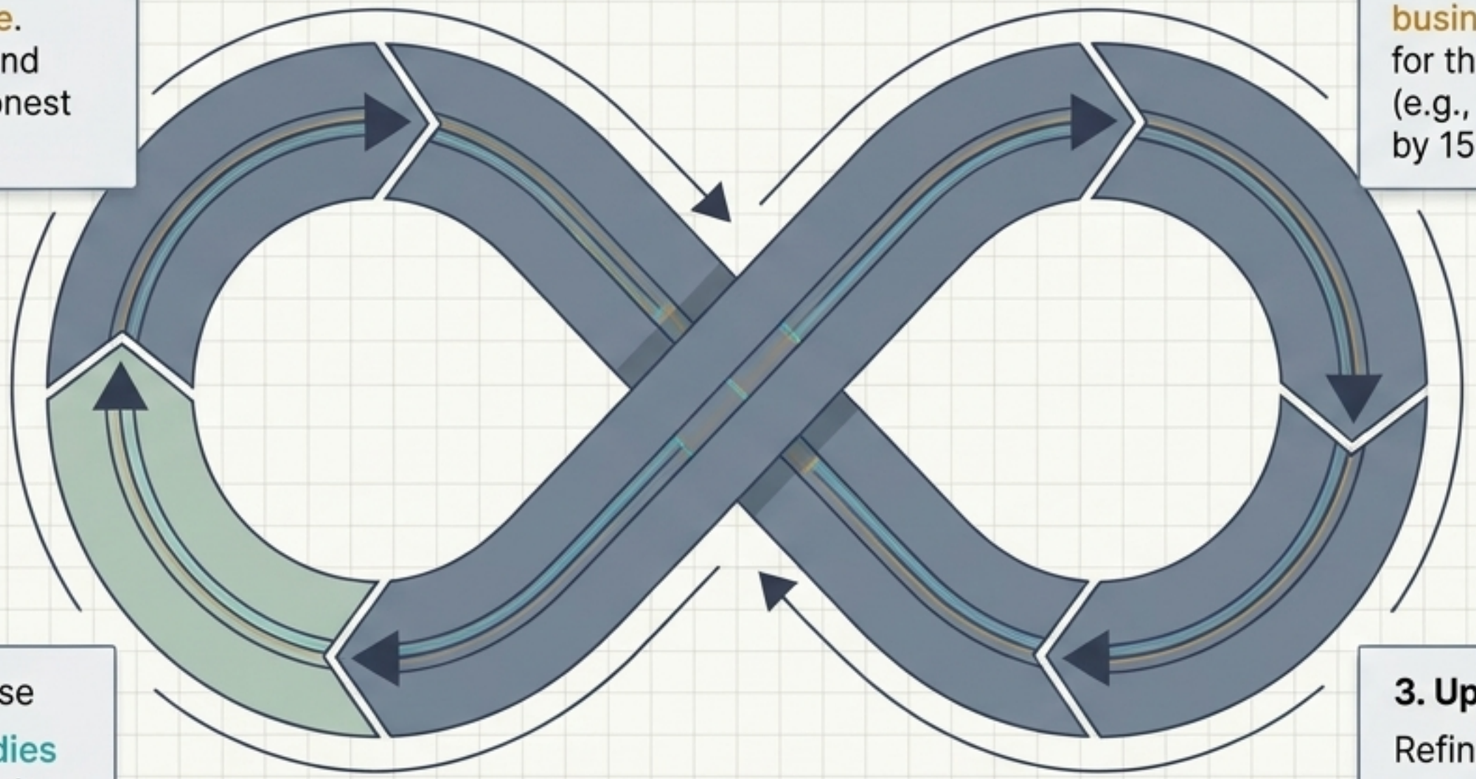
Artifact Repository: A single source of truth with version control and traceability mapping. Documentation effort should match its value.

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Phase 4 (Management): Closing the loop to measure value and improve the practice

1. Review Delivered Value:
Compare delivered results against the business case estimate. Assess both tangible ROI and intangible alignment. Be honest about shortfalls.

2. Set SMART Goals:
Use review findings and business strategy to set goals for the architecture function (e.g., "reduce engagement time by 15%").



3. Update Engagement Model:
Refine triggers, adjust governance checkpoints, and right-size the delivery plan based on lessons learned.

4. Communicate Value: Use dashboards and case studies to present results to executives in their language, securing ongoing support.

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The Integration Matrix: Deploying capabilities across the project lifecycle.

Phase 2
Design and Quality Attributes dominate as logical and product-specific blueprints are drafted.

Phase 3
IT Environment (Governance) and Human Dynamics (Stakeholder Mgmt, Negotiation) are critical to prevent drift.

Phase 1
Biz Tech Strategy peaks heavily here (Business Valuation, Prioritization)

Phase 4
Human Dynamics (Presentation) and Biz Strategy (Decision Support) close the loop to communicate value.

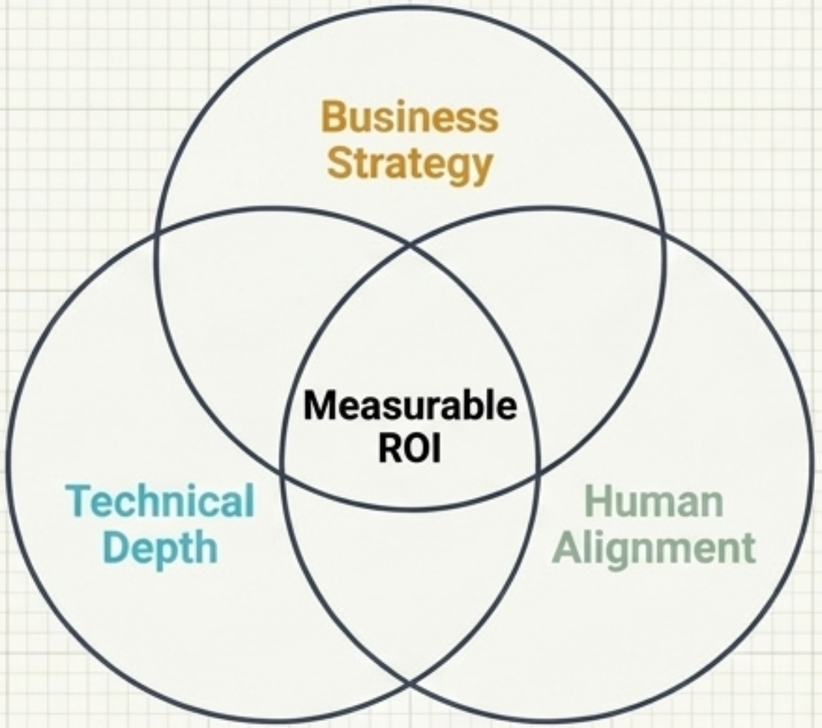
The Master Integration Matrix

X-Axis

Y-Axis: 5 Pillars	**Phase 1:** Selection	**Phase 2:** Creation	**Phase 3:** Delivery	**Phase 4:** Management
Design				
IT Environment				
Quality Attributes				
Biz Tech Strategy				
Human Dynamics				

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The Holistic Architect



The Foundation: Architecture is a defined profession demanding whole-system thinking, environmental awareness, and a grasp of quality attributes.
The Translation: Success relies on translating business context into technical direction, and technical realities back into executive language.
The Lifecycle: Value is not created in a diagram; it is estimated in selection, engineered in creation, protected in delivery, and proven in management.

The architect delivers measurable business value through the relentless alignment of technology with human and strategic realities.

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